

F5 Daily Briefing - Monday, September 14, 2026

Daily competitive intelligence covering 22 F5 competitors

22

COMPETITORS TRACKED

18

ANNOUNCEMENTS

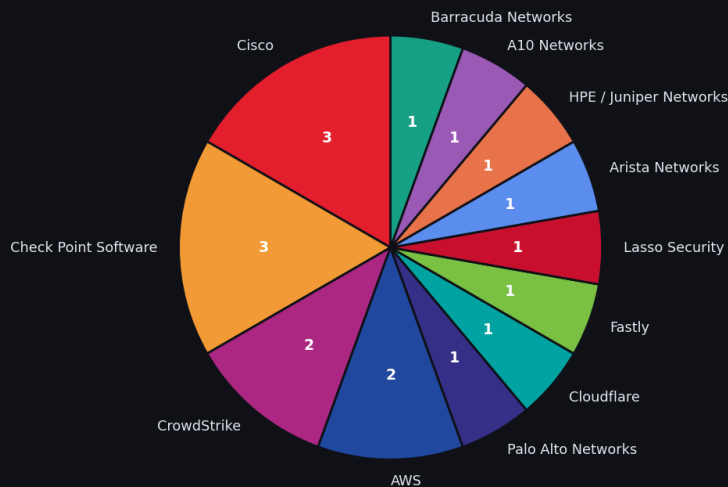
12

ACTIVE

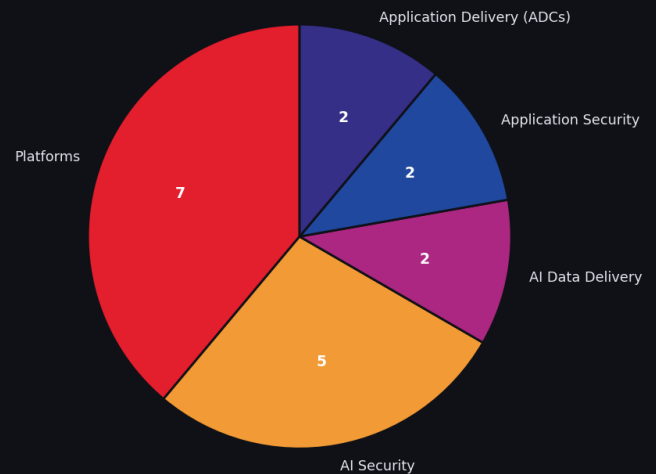
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ACTIVE CATEGORIES

Announcements by Competitor



Announcements by Category



ALL ANNOUNCEMENTS (18)

ANNOUNCEMENT **Palo Alto Networks** 2026-09-14

Palo Alto Networks Quantum-Safe Security Earns FedRAMP Moderate Authorization

Palo Alto Networks announced FedRAMP Moderate authorization for its Quantum-Safe Security (QSS) solution, a turnkey Automated Cryptography Discovery and Inventory platform, clearing U.S. federal agencies to deploy it immediately for sensitive unclassified data. QSS uses existing firewalls as sensors to turn networks into automated, real-time cryptographic control points without new hardware. The certification supports federal post-quantum deadlines of key establishment by December 2030 and digital signatures by December 2031, positioning the platform as a ready path for agencies modernizing cryptography.

<https://www.paloaltonetworks.com/blog/2026/09/fedramp-moderate-authorization-for-palo-alto-networks-quantum-safe-security/>

PRODUCT LAUNCH **Cisco** 2026-09-14

Cisco Expands Native Splunk in Nexus One to Multi-Node Architecture

At Splunk .conf26, Cisco expanded Native Splunk in Cisco Nexus One from a single-node to a multi-node architecture, unifying Splunk analytics with authoritative network context in one operational experience. The multi-node Nexus One and Nexus Dashboard deployment delivers high availability, maintenance flexibility, and configurable sizing for critical data center workloads. The update builds on Cisco's February 2026 Cisco Live Amsterdam announcement and advances Cisco's single-pane observability-plus-networking consolidation story.

<https://blogs.cisco.com/datacenter/closing-the-resilience-gap-with-native-splunk-in-cisco-nexus-one>

ANNOUNCEMENT Cisco 2026-09-14

Cisco Issues Critical Security Hardening Release for Secure Email Gateway

Cisco published a critical September 2026 security hardening release for Cisco Secure Email Gateway and Secure Email and Web Manager, addressing multiple internally discovered vulnerabilities including at least one actively exploited flaw with a CVSS score up to 9.8. Both products are affected regardless of configuration, with no workarounds available; Cisco Secure Web Appliance is unaffected. Flaws span path traversal, improper access control, injection, and input validation. Cisco directs customers to fixed releases across the 15.5, 16.0, and 16.5 lineages.

<https://sec.cloudapps.cisco.com/security/center/content/CiscoSecurityAdvisory/cisco-sa-hardening-esa-dfCrFXkm>

PRODUCT LAUNCH Cisco 2026-09-14

Cisco AI POD for Splunk Reaches General Availability with NVIDIA

Cisco and Splunk announced general availability of Cisco AI POD for Splunk at .conf26, delivering on-premises GPU-accelerated AI for Splunk Enterprise where data resides. Built on NVIDIA-Certified Systems with NVIDIA AI Enterprise and Nemotron open models, it pairs Cisco Secure AI Factory with a Kubernetes-based AI runtime pre-validated for Splunk workloads. Two deployment options are offered: turnkey Cisco/NVIDIA hardware or a software layer on customer infrastructure. The goal is high-performance inference at scale for agentic SOC use cases under data sovereignty constraints.

<https://www.pubt.io/view/C9D85D364F55EEBF7EBD65289FD83C44CFE9F3DF>

PARTNERSHIP CrowdStrike 2026-09-14

HCLTech and CrowdStrike Expand Partnership to Advance AI Security and Resilience

CrowdStrike and HCLTech expanded their strategic partnership to integrate CrowdStrike Falcon Guardian with HCLTech's AI Security and Resilience services, spanning advisory, governance, implementation, and managed services delivered through HCLTech Cybersecurity Fusion Centers. Falcon Guardian contributes AI detection and response for the AI attack surface, combined with HCLTech's TRiBe AI trust and risk governance framework and VERITY Frontier AI Resilience operating model. Building on their March 2026 Continuous Threat Exposure Management work, the partners aim to secure AI applications, models, agents, identities, and data across hybrid environments.

<https://www.crowdstrike.com/en-us/press-releases/hcltech-crowdstrike-expand-strategic-partnership-advancing-ai-security-resilience/>

PARTNERSHIP CrowdStrike 2026-09-14

Zip Security Joins CrowdStrike Project QuiltWorks to Secure SMBs Against Frontier AI Risk

CrowdStrike extended Project QuiltWorks to the SMB market, adding Zip Security as a partner to bring frontier AI risk protection to organizations without a CISO, security team, or dedicated budget. Zip delivers an automated end-to-end security framework with 24/7 protection, on-demand compliance evidence, and a network of virtual CISOs that implement and enforce prescribed security programs. The expansion leverages CrowdStrike's distributor, MSP/MSSP, and channel ecosystem to push enterprise-grade AI risk coverage down-market.

<https://www.prnewswire.com/news-releases/zip-security-joins-crowdstrikes-project-quiltworks-to-secure-smbs-against-frontier-ai-risk-302878146.html>

EXECUTIVE MOVE **Check Point Software** 2026-09-14

Check Point Appoints Yoram Tietz to Board of Directors

Check Point Software announced the appointment of veteran Israeli technology adviser Yoram Tietz to its Board of Directors. Executive Chairman Gil Shwed framed the addition as valuable amid a major technology shift, citing Tietz's experience guiding technology firms from early stage to global leadership. The company filed a Form 6-K with the SEC highlighting the governance step as it pursues an AI-focused cyber security strategy. Check Point shares gained roughly 7% following the announcement.

<https://www.tipranks.com/news/company-announcements/check-point-adds-veteran-tech-adviser-yoram-tietz-to-board-amid-ai-focused-cyber-strategy>

THREAT INTELLIGENCE **Check Point Software** 2026-09-14

Check Point Exposes Voicemail-Themed Credential Phishing Campaign Hitting 7,800+ Organizations

Check Point detailed a large-scale credential phishing campaign that abused automated voicemail-transcript notification emails, running August 17-31, 2026 against more than 7,800 organizations with over 58,000 emails, 38,000 spoofed sender addresses, and 9,300 spoofed domains. SVG attachments executed embedded scripts that redirected victims to credential-harvesting pages pre-filled with their email address to boost credibility. Check Point argued reputation-based defenses are insufficient and recommended multi-layered analysis of sender behavior, attachment traits, and URL intent, plus restricting AI agents from opening attachments autonomously.

<https://blog.checkpoint.com/security/fake-voicemail-transcript-emails-target-7800-organizations-in-large-scale-credential-phishing/>

THREAT INTELLIGENCE **Check Point Software** 2026-09-14

Check Point Research Reports Ransomware Nearly Doubling and Rising GenAI Prompt Risk

Check Point Research published its weekly Threat Intelligence Report covering early September 2026, finding average weekly cyberattacks per organization rose 22% year over year to 2,422 and recording 1,042 ransomware attacks, nearly double the August 2025 figure. Enterprise GenAI usage grew to an average of 106 prompts per user, with 86% of organizations using GenAI experiencing high-risk prompt activity. The report positions AI data exposure as an emerging enterprise risk category alongside conventional ransomware growth.

<https://research.checkpoint.com/2026/14th-september-threat-intelligence-report/>

PRODUCT LAUNCH **Cloudflare** 2026-09-14

Cloudflare and OpenAI Automate Vulnerability Discovery and Patching at the Edge

Cloudflare launched a Vulnerability Discovery and Remediation service, in early access through Cloudflare Managed Defense and powered by OpenAI's Daybreak Defense Network including GPT-5.6 Cyber. The service correlates live traffic from Cloudflare's network with code analysis to prioritize high-risk vulnerabilities, deploys edge WAF rules to neutralize exploits before patching, and generates candidate patch code for human approval. It spans Web Assets, WAF, and Workers Observability, positioning Cloudflare's WAF as a virtual-patching control plane rather than a reactive rule set.

<https://securitymea.com/2026/09/14/cloudflare-partners-with-openai-daybreak-models/>

PRODUCT LAUNCH **AWS** 2026-09-14

AWS Makes OpenAI GPT-6 Astra Generally Available on Amazon Bedrock Alongside Quick Desktop and Outposts Updates

AWS announced general availability of OpenAI's GPT-6 Astra on Amazon Bedrock, with a context window up to 1,000,000 tokens and stronger reasoning and browser-use capabilities for complex business workflows. The same update brought the Amazon Quick desktop app to GA on macOS and Windows, longer-running Lambda execution, AWS Outposts single-rack deployment GA, Amazon OpenSearch Serverless on Vercel's v0, and AWS Transform for .NET modernization. The bundle reinforces Bedrock as the default enterprise inference control plane and extends AWS reach into on-premises and agentic workloads.

<https://aws.amazon.com/blogs/aws/aws-weekly-roundup-openai-gpt-6-astra-on-amazon-bedrock-amazon-quick-desktop-ga-kiro-for-students-and-more-september-14-2026/>

RESEARCH **AWS** 2026-09-14

AWS Benchmark Finds AI Vulnerability Detection Buried in False Positives

Research on an AWS deception benchmark tested how well AI models detect real software vulnerabilities and found that false positives pile up quickly, undermining automated triage. The findings temper vendor claims that large language models can autonomously discover and confirm exploitable flaws, showing that human validation and runtime context remain necessary. For security teams, the result argues that runtime protection and virtual patching are more dependable near-term controls than AI-generated vulnerability verdicts alone.

<https://www.helpnetsecurity.com/2026/09/14/aws-deception-benchmark-security-vulnerabilities/>

EARNINGS **Fastly** 2026-09-14

Fastly Touts Accelerating Growth, Record Margins and AI-Driven Compute Demand at Citi TMT Conference

Fastly told investors at Citi's TMT Conference that revenue grew 23.3% year over year to \$183 million, with delivery up 17%, security up 43%, and compute/observability up 69%. The company reported a record 65.8% gross margin, roughly 15% operating margin, four consecutive profitable quarters, and six straight quarters of positive free cash flow. Management framed compute — about \$7 million in the quarter — as its fastest-growing area on early AI use cases, and guided capital expenditures to 10–12% of revenue as it pushes beyond CDN into security and edge compute.

<https://www.marketbeat.com/instant-alerts/event-fastly-highlights-accelerating-growth-record-margins-and-ai-driven-compute-demand-2026-09-14/>

ANNOUNCEMENT **Lasso Security** 2026-09-14

Lasso Named a Sample Vendor in Gartner's Hype Cycle for Artificial Intelligence, 2026

Lasso Security announced its inclusion as a sample vendor under AI Governance Technologies in Gartner's Hype Cycle for Artificial Intelligence, 2026, listed alongside Databricks, Google, IBM, Microsoft, OneTrust, ServiceNow and Zenity. Gartner frames the category as tooling that operationalizes AI policy across the full AI lifecycle — oversight, risk management, compliance, observability and security — at 5–20% market penetration and 5–10 years from mainstream adoption. Lasso used the recognition to position its closed loop of discovery, AI risk management, automated red teaming and runtime protection as real-time policy enforcement rather than periodic audit.

<https://www.lasso.security/blog/lasso-named-in-gartners-hype-cycle-for-artificial-intelligence-2026>

THREAT INTELLIGENCE**Arista Networks** 2026-09-14

Arista Security Advisories Spotlight Growing EOS and CloudVision Patch Burden in AI Fabrics

Analysis published September 14 examines Arista's recent batch of critical PSIRT security advisories covering EOS and CloudVision, alongside comparable Cisco disclosures. The piece argues the most actionable risk in AI data center networking now sits in the software and management layer rather than the switching hardware, making patch cadence, observability, and automated upgrades central to keeping AI fabrics healthy. It frames EOS and CloudVision as Arista's durable moat while noting that ongoing fabric maintenance is becoming a larger share of the operational workload for AI-scale deployments.

<https://news-area.com/2026/09/14/arista-released-critical-security-advisories-cisco-shows-why-ai-network-growth-also-creates-repair-work/>

ANNOUNCEMENT**HPE / Juniper Networks** 2026-09-14

HPE Pushes Unified 'Self-Driving Network' Vision Across Aruba and Juniper Portfolios

HPE detailed its self-driving network strategy, positioning the combined HPE Aruba Networking and HPE Juniper Networking portfolios as a single AI-driven operational model spanning campus, branch, data center, and WAN. Shared agentic AI capabilities across HPE Mist, HPE Marvis, and HPE Aruba Central are pitched as unified operational intelligence, with Marvis providing conversational, proactive troubleshooting and Aruba Central CoP covering on-premises control. HPE emphasizes customer choice within one vendor portfolio and a progressive path toward more autonomous network management.

<https://www.intelligentcio.com/me/2026/09/14/towards-the-self-driving-network/>

EXECUTIVE MOVE**A10 Networks** 2026-09-14

A10 Networks Appoints Mary C. Henry to Board of Directors

A10 Networks named Mary C. Henry to its Board of Directors effective October 5, 2026, expanding the board from five to six members. Henry spent 18 years at Goldman Sachs as a communications technology analyst, becoming Partner and Managing Director before retiring, and currently serves on the board of iCivics. A10 framed the addition as strengthening board oversight as the company pursues growth tied to AI infrastructure and AI security, including its recently launched A10 AI Gateway control plane.

<https://www.financialcontent.com/article/bizwire-2026-9-14-a10-networks-appoints-mary-c-henry-to-the-board-of-directors>

THREAT INTELLIGENCE**Barracuda Networks** 2026-09-14

Barracuda Threat Research Warns of "Fake Worker" Infiltration by Famous Chollima

Barracuda published research on the fake worker threat, in which state-linked operatives use fraudulent identities to win remote roles and gain legitimate access. It attributes the tactic largely to Famous Chollima (UNC5267 / Jasper Sleet / Wagemole), tied to roughly 47% of state-sponsored intrusions against tech firms from April 2025 to May 2026, targeting aerospace, defense, blockchain/DeFi and software companies in the U.S. and Europe. Barracuda argues the attack surface now includes recruiting, onboarding, payroll and contractor management, and positions Barracuda Managed XDR for continuous post-hire behavioral monitoring.

<https://fr.blog.barracuda.com/2026/09/14/the-fake-worker-threat-and-the-rise-of-human-infiltration>